

QROO SPANISH CREW

https://youtu.be/tTlaZ3_kS8I

Lesson Summary: The Many Uses of 'Llegar' in Spanish

Introduction

Hey everybody, Qroo Paul here! In this lesson, we're diving into one of my favorite verbs: *llegar*. It's a *mega verb*, meaning it has a ton of different uses that are crucial for speaking Spanish fluently. While people usually think of verbs like *ser*, *estar*, and *tener* as essential, *llegar* is just as important.

This video was inspired by a question from a member of my private learning group, the Qroo Spanish Crew, who noticed an unexpected use of *llegar*. That led me to create this deep dive into all the different ways we can use this versatile verb.

1. The Basic Meaning: 'Llegar a' = To Arrive At a Place

The most common use of *llegar* is "to arrive." However, in English, we often say "get" instead of "arrive." This is important to remember when translating.

- ¿A qué hora llegaste a la oficina? – What time did you get to the office?
- ¿A qué hora llegaste a casa? – What time did you get home?

Remember to learn verbs with their prepositions! With *llegar*, you use *llegar a* (to arrive at/to a place).

Pronunciation Note:

Some Spanish speakers pronounce *ll* like an English "Y" (*llegar*), while others pronounce it like a soft "J" (*jegar*). In Argentina and Uruguay, it can sound like "sh." All are correct—just pick the one you're comfortable with!

2. 'Llegar a + Infinitive' = To Manage to / To Eventually Do Something

This structure expresses reaching a state or achieving something over time.

- Después de muchos años, llegó a ser presidente. – After many years, he became president. (Literally, "he arrived at being president.")

- *Con el tiempo, llegarás a entenderlo.* – With time, you'll come to understand it.
 - *Si sigues entrenando, llegarás a correr un maratón.* – If you keep training, you'll eventually run a marathon.
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3. 'Llegar' = To Receive (Messages, Calls, Packages)

In Spanish, *llegar* is commonly used to mean "to receive" something like messages or packages, whereas English speakers tend to use *recibir*.

- *Me llegaron dos mensajes de texto.* – I got two text messages. (Literally, "Two text messages arrived to me.")
 - *Nos llegó un paquete de México.* – We received a package from Mexico.
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4. 'Llegar a' = To Reach a Certain Amount or Level

This usage is common with numbers and milestones.

- *El video llegó a un millón de vistas.* – The video reached a million views.
 - *Mi abuelo llegó a los noventa años.* – My grandfather made it to 90 years old.
 - *El precio llegó a los cincuenta dólares.* – The price reached \$50.
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5. 'Llegar hasta' = To Extend To / To Cover a Distance

Often used with *hasta* (meaning "up until").

- *El agua llegó hasta la puerta.* – The water reached the door.
 - *La fila llega hasta la esquina.* – The line goes all the way to the corner.
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6. 'Llegar' = To Have an Emotional Impact

Llegar can express being emotionally moved by something.

- *Sus palabras me llegaron al corazón.* – His words touched my heart. (Literally, "arrived at my heart.")
- *Esa película me llegó mucho.* – That movie really got to me.

Alternative verb: *Conmover* (to move emotionally), but this lesson focuses on *llegar*.

7. 'Llegar para' = To Be Enough / Sufficient

- *No me llega el dinero para comprarlo.* – I don't have enough money to buy it.
(Literally, "The money doesn't arrive to me to buy it.")
 - *Con esto no llega para todos.* – With this, it's not enough for everyone.
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8. 'Llegar tan lejos' = To Get So Far / Come So Far

Great phrase for when you're talking about progress.

- *Nadie imaginaba que Sofía llegaría tan lejos en su carrera.* – No one imagined that Sofía would get so far in her career.
 - *Es increíble que la tecnología haya llegado tan lejos en tan poco tiempo.* – It's incredible that technology has come so far in such a short time.
 - *Grammar Note: Es increíble que* triggers the subjunctive (*haya llegado*).
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9. 'Llegar a' + Infinitive = To Go As Far As (Extreme Actions)

Used to express someone taking something to an extreme.

- *En la discusión, Mario llegó a insultar a su jefe.* – In the argument, Mario even went as far as insulting his boss.
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10. Common Expressions with 'Llegar'

Here are three more useful expressions with *llegar*:

- **Llegar a golpes** – To come to blows
 - *Los candidatos llegaron a golpes.* – The candidates came to blows.
- **Llegar al fondo de algo** – To get to the bottom of something
 - *Tenemos que llegar al fondo de esto.* – We have to get to the bottom of this.
- **Llegar a un acuerdo** – To arrive at an agreement

- *Los candidatos llegaron a un acuerdo.* – The candidates arrived at an agreement.

Conclusion

That wraps up our deep dive into *llegar*! This verb is way more than just "to arrive"—it can express achieving something, receiving things, covering distances, having emotional impact, and more. Learning how to use *llegar* in different contexts will boost your fluency and make your Spanish sound more natural.

If you enjoyed this lesson, give it a thumbs up and keep practicing. Until next time, *hasta luego!*